

AI MARKETPLACE

Open Decisions

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Purpose

This document tracks unresolved product and technical decisions that block or shape downstream work. Each entry stays open until explicitly resolved; once resolved, move the outcome into `09_DECISIONS.md` (or `11_MVP_SCOPE.md` if it's a scope change) and mark the entry here as **Closed**, with a reference to where it landed. Do not delete resolved entries — mark them closed and keep the record.

1. Category Taxonomy

Status: **Open — Blocking**

Why it matters: The category taxonomy structures both provider listings and the AI's category-specific question flows. Stage 2 (AI intake) implementation cannot start until this is locked, per `03_DOMAIN_MODEL.md`.

What needs deciding: The initial narrow set of categories to launch with, and the question-template structure per category that drives the AI's follow-up questions.

Input available: Admin-side search analytics (`11_MVP_SCOPE.md` Section 1) is designed to help answer this from real search behavior — but that data doesn't exist pre-launch. An initial hypothesis list is needed to launch at all; analytics then refine it.

2. Cross-Platform Mobile Framework

Status: **Open**

Why it matters: Native iOS/Android was confirmed as the launch platform (superseding the original responsive-web MVP scope). A single cross-platform codebase is recommended over separate native builds, but the specific framework isn't chosen.

Options considered: Flutter, React Native.

Notes: No technical constraint from this project's own documents favors one over the other — this is an open call, not a documented default to inherit.

3. Google Places Data — Legal / ToS Review

Status: **Open — Blocking for the Google-seeded business supply strategy**

Why it matters: Business supply is planned to be bootstrapped in part from publicly available Google listings. Google's Places API terms restrict how place data can be cached and reused, including limits relevant to building a competing directory from it.

What needs deciding: Confirm current Google Places API terms (or get a quick legal read) before importing business listings in bulk. Until resolved, imported listings must be flagged internally as **unclaimed** and not treated as equivalent to verified, self-registered providers.

4. Unclaimed Listing UX

Status: **Open** — depends on Item 3

Why it matters: Businesses pulled in from Google haven't opted in and may receive calls/messages they didn't expect.

What needs deciding: Whether unclaimed listings are hidden from search until claimed, or shown with a clear "unclaimed — unverified" label. Also determines the design of the claim-listing flow (search name → OTP verify against public record → admin fallback), already included in [11_MVP_SCOPE.md](#) Section 1.

5. Business Verification Bar

Status: **Open**

Why it matters: Per [03_DOMAIN_MODEL.md](#), a Freelancer cannot go live until Verification status is Approved (mandatory license/ID check). A Business Provider's verification bar is explicitly lighter and configurable, but the exact bar hasn't been set.

Options considered: Trade license check, phone/address verification only, or self-declared with a later "verified" upgrade path.

Related: Ties directly into Item 4 (unclaimed listings) — a claimed-but-unverified Google listing and a self-registered business may need different verification treatment.

6. App Store Policy on Off-Platform Payment

Status: **Open** — Should be resolved before development begins

Why it matters: Apple App Store review scrutinizes marketplace apps that connect users for services ultimately paid off-platform, which is this product's model (contact exchanged in-app, payment handled offline between customer and provider).

What needs deciding: A resolution strategy for submission — e.g. clear framing in review notes that no digital goods or services are transacted through the app itself. Risk of rejection or required changes at submission if left unaddressed.

7. Future Monetization Mechanism

Status: **Open** — not blocking MVP, but data-collection decisions now depend on the answer

Why it matters: Removing contact-gating at launch (a deliberate growth-first decision, see [11_MVP_SCOPE.md](#) Purpose) removes pay-per-lead as a straightforward later revenue option. Whatever model comes later can't depend on withholding contact info that users will already expect to be free.

Candidates on the table: Featured/priority placement (visibility boost), verified-badge or premium-profile subscription. Provider-facing visibility analytics and the digital-storefront profile framing (both in [11_MVP_SCOPE.md](#)) were added specifically to make either of these an easier, non-disruptive upsell later.

What needs deciding: Not the final pricing model — just enough directional agreement that the data being collected now (visibility stats, outcome tags, review volume) is the data a later pricing decision will actually need.

8. App Name, Domain, and Trademark

Status: Open

Why it matters: Working title only; branding, App Store/Play Store listing, and marketing all depend on this being locked.

What needs deciding: Final name, domain availability, and a basic trademark check before public launch.

9. Launch Market Confirmation

Status: Open (low urgency — default assumed, not yet formally locked)

Why it matters: 00_PROJECT_CONTEXT.md names UAE as the likely launch market (reusing existing Emirates ID/Ejari-style verification tooling) but explicitly frames this as an open decision, not a locked assumption. The product's architecture is meant to stay country-agnostic.

What needs deciding: Formal confirmation of UAE as launch market — or an explicit decision to launch elsewhere first — so it can be treated as settled rather than a carried assumption.

Related Documents

- 00_PROJECT_CONTEXT.md
- 03_DOMAIN_MODEL.md
- 09_DECISIONS.md
- 11_MVP_SCOPE.md

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